

THEGAPBRIEF · SIDE REPORT · NOVEMBER 4, 2026

The Grok Bot Usage Squeeze: What Changed, What's Confirmed

Around Halloween weekend, many Grok Bot users' weekly meters jumped or ran out early. Elon Musk said serving costs were "unsustainably high relative to revenue." As of Nov 4, no official page publishes new limit numbers.

Assigned by Jacob Peterson · Research covers Oct 28 – Nov 4, 2026, checked Nov 4. Every item is tagged **[Official]** (company docs or posts by company leaders), **[Press]** (news reporting), **[User report]** (posts and forum threads, not verified) or **[Speculation]**. Replies from the @grok account on X are AI-generated answers, not company statements, and are tagged as such. Companion report: Running a Bot Team on Less.

SUMMARY Bottom line

1 A cost squeeze is confirmed. New numbers are not.

Confirmed: on Nov 1 Musk wrote "The cost of serving Grok Bot was unsustainably high relative to revenue." Official docs say Grok Bot draws on one weekly pool shared with Grok and Cursor, and that tiers differ by multiples (Premium 4x, Super 15x, Ultra 50x of Plus). **Not confirmed:** any specific new weekly limit, a percentage cut, or an effective date. Neither xAI nor Cursor has published one, and the press reports none.

Musk on X, Nov 1 · x.ai/pricing · xAI docs: Usage limits · TechCrunch, Nov 2

1 Timeline, Oct 28 – Nov 4

1.1 Nov 1 (overnight): meters jump *[User report]*

On Cursor's forum and X, users reported weekly meters that doubled overnight or within hours: 33%→66%, 34%→73% (Pro+), 47.5%→95%, 55%→100%. A Cursor Ultra user saw the meter flip between 74%, 77% and 100%. Some saw a lower figure inside the bot than in Settings (24% vs 48%), and one usage CSV showed no activity during a jump. Users cited reset dates from Nov 5 to Nov 7. No staff explanation appeared in the forum thread captured Nov 1.

Data Studios, summary of the forum reports · The Next Web · @dvorahfr on X, Nov 1

1.2 Nov 1: a Cursor billing and dashboard incident *[Press]*

Forbes, as cited by The Next Web, reported that Cursor flagged a billing and usage-dashboard problem on Sunday, later marked resolved. It is not clear whether it caused the meter jumps.

The Next Web, citing Forbes

1.3 Nov 1: Musk on cost *[Official]*

Asked for a usage reset by @DogecoinNorway, Musk replied "The cost of serving Grok Bot was unsustainably high relative to revenue." To another user who had hit the limit, he replied "Upgrade to higher usage plan cost increase is too high?" He did not give numbers, say limits were cut, or promise a reset. Some users read his past tense ("was") as saying allowances had already been cut. The post itself doesn't say that.

Musk, Nov 1 · Musk, Nov 1 (upgrade reply) · Data Studios

1.4 Nov 2–3: press coverage *[Press]*

TechCrunch's headline says Musk "throttles" the limits, yet the article notes he "has not yet shared how subscribers' usage limits will be impacted moving forward." Fortune adds context from SpaceX's Oct 20 Q3 call: Gwynne Shotwell said Grok Bot hit 800,000 paid weekly users in early October, double September's count. Musk said users are "use it more per week, not use it less."

TechCrunch, Nov 2 · Fortune, Nov 3 · Business Insider

1.5 Nov 1–4: features keep shipping *[Official]*

During the same week, Musk promoted new Grok Bot features: phone calls (Nov 3), shopping and order tracking (Nov 3–4), and complex trip booking (Nov 3). These are agentic, multi-step tasks, which is the kind of work Fortune says costs the most to serve.

Musk: calls, Nov 3 · @bot: shopping, Nov 3 · Musk: trips, Nov 3 · Fortune

2 What the official pages say now (checked Nov 4)

Plan (The X Subscription)	Price	Included usage	Grok Bot
Plus	$8/mo	Shared pool (base)	No
Premium	$30/mo	4x Plus	Yes
Super	$100/mo	15x Plus	Yes
Ultra	$200/mo	50x Plus	Yes

Source: x.ai/pricing, checked Nov 4, 2026. The page gives multiples only, with no absolute token or task counts.

2.1 One shared weekly pool *[Official]*

Grok Bot doesn't have its own meter. It draws from the seat's weekly pool along with Grok Chat, Imagine, Voice and Cursor. Usage rates vary by product, and the pool refreshes weekly. Data Studios reports the pricing, usage-limits and FAQ pages still carried their Oct 11–12 versions as of Nov 2.

xAI docs: Usage limits · Cursor help: Plans and billing · Data Studios

2.2 After the pool runs out *[Official]*

You can wait for the reset, pay from prepaid credit (top-ups or Auto Top-up), or upgrade. A monthly additional-usage limit caps spending even when credit remains. Cursor says requests are "never downgraded in quality or speed." Legacy Cursor plans like Jacob's use an on-demand monthly limit instead. The None/Fixed/Unlimited setting reposted as "new" on X on Nov 4 actually dates to changelog v0.25.0 (Aug 25).

Cursor: Models & Pricing · Cursor help: Plans · WSMBD, citing the Grok Bot changelog · X post, Nov 4

2.3 Legacy Cursor Ultra *[Official]*

Legacy Cursor Ultra is listed as "Highest weekly usage" for Grok Bot, with no number. Unifying into The X Subscription is optional, but once it's done it can't be undone, and Support can't reverse it.

Cursor help: Plans · xAI docs: Grok Bot on The X Subscription

2.4 Free resets: past ones are official, a new one is not *[Official]*

Global resets were announced on Aug 26, Sep 1, Sep 5 and Oct 2. None was announced for this squeeze as of Nov 4. The documented way to get a reset is the referral program.

WSMBD (links each official post) · Cursor help: Plans

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3 User reports and speculation

3.1 "Limits were cut" *[Speculation]*

X posts on Nov 4 say limits "got tighter." No official source gives the size of any cut, and WSMBD found no official page saying limits were reduced. Because the pool is stated only in multiples, no one can confirm or rule out a cut from public pages.

@AkbarLalani, Nov 4 · WSMBD

3.2 A per-bot usage breakdown in testing *[User report]*

One user says Grok Bot is "testing a usage breakdown by bot." There's no official confirmation.

@an0ym0u5, Nov 4

3.3 Group chats and routines drain the pool *[User report]*

Users say group chats where "every message woke every bot" were their biggest waste. Their fix is to keep bots silent unless named and run routines on a schedule.

@justdesigncn, Nov 4

3.4 Users leaving or upgrading *[User report]*

Some users say they upgraded ahead of more cuts. Others say they moved their bots to other platforms. These are individual posts, not trends.

@CostaKapo · @FranciswongCro · @phiveoh13 (all Nov 4)

3.5 @grok's answers *[AI answer, not official]*

@grok replies repeat the docs (shared weekly pool, Ultra at 50x, unification is permanent) and Musk's cost statement. They add nothing beyond the official pages.

@grok, Nov 4

4 What this means for Jacob's bot team

4.1 Where Jacob stands

[Jacob's data] On Nov 2: legacy Cursor Ultra, **74.6%** of the weekly limit used, resetting **Thu Nov 5, 12:10 PT**. On-demand was **$20.47 of the $30** monthly limit, which covers Grok Bot and Cursor together.

- **Budget for a smaller week.** Nothing official rules out a smaller pool, and the CEO is talking about cost. The $30 on-demand cap is the hard stop; only $9.53 was left as of Nov 2.
- **Don't unify yet.** Legacy Ultra is listed as the highest weekly usage, and unifying can't be undone. Compare after official numbers appear.
- **Cut the big drains first:** the Kapsoul bots (about 40%), bot-to-bot chatter, and polling routines. The levers are in Running a Bot Team on Less.
- **Check after Thursday's reset.** Compare how fast the meter climbs against last week, and watch for sudden jumps like the Nov 1 reports.

Jacob's usage report, Nov 2 · Cursor help: Plans · xAI docs

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